

‘Anytime, anyplace you bring up school closings, it’s a battle.’

PAUL REVILLE, *a former state education secretary*

Wu praised, criticized for taking on school closures

Election year could complicate a potential no-win situation

By Emma Platoff and Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

With her first major policy announcement of this reelection year, Mayor Michelle Wu jumped directly into one of Boston’s greatest political controversies: closing public schools.

It’s a painful necessity in the city, where enrollment has been in sharp decline for more than a decade. But the proposal to

close three schools and consolidate two others also makes for thorny politics, particularly as Wu seeks a second term this fall. No family wants to bid adieu to a beloved neighborhood school, even though many education experts and city leaders agree that closures are necessary to ensure a fair distribution of resources.

Familiar criticism greeted Wu and Superintendent Mary Skipper after they announced

Tuesday that they would seek to close Excel High School in South Boston, Dever Elementary School in Dorchester, and the Mary Lyon Pilot High School in Allston/Brighton, while consolidating Winthrop and Clap Elementary Schools. Some critics faulted city leaders for not engaging more with the affected communities in advance of the announcement. Others argued

WU, Page A7

SJC backs housing law, but calls for changes

Guidelines for MBTA Communities Act must be rewritten, possibly slowing down process for towns

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

The state’s highest court on Wednesday upheld a controversial state housing law and ruled that Attorney General Andrea Campbell has the authority to sue cities and towns to force them to comply with it, a major legal win for a policy that state officials say is key to building out of Massachusetts’ vast housing shortage.

But the justices also delivered a setback that may slow implementation of the MBTA Communities Act, saying the detailed guidelines issued by the state that municipalities must follow were created improperly and must go through a formal regulatory process.

The unanimous ruling of the Supreme Judicial Court answers a key question that has been central to the debate around the law, which requires 177 cities and towns served by the T to make it easier to build multifamily housing: Compliance, the court said, is not optional, and Campbell has the power to take legal action to compel cities and towns that resist, as she did against Milton after voters there overturned an MBTA Communities plan in February.

“In light of the Attorney General’s unique and well established role as a protector of public rights, we conclude that the penalties provided for in the act do not preclude the equitable relief

DECISION, Page A10

Out-of-control fires terrorize Los Angeles

Hurricane-force winds stoke flames, giving thousands little time to escape; Pacific Palisades hit hard



ETHAN SWOPE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

(Above) Residents of a senior center were evacuated in Altadena, Calif., as the Eaton fire (right) approached. (Far right) The Pacific Palisades neighborhood was ravaged in a fire considered the most destructive in the modern history of Los Angeles.



JOSH EDELSON/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES



DAMIAN DOVARGANES/ASSOCIATED PRESS

By Corina Knoll and Thomas Fuller

NEW YORK TIMES

LOS ANGELES — A series of firestorms raging out of control in Los Angeles on Wednesday decimated the affluent neighborhood of Pacific Palisades and was threatening an ever wider swath of America’s most populous county as night fell.

Propelled by howling, hurricane-force winds that served as a kind of hellish bellows, the blazes came with the terrifying prospect for the 10 million residents of Los Angeles County that further infernos could erupt in any place at any moment.

At least five people were killed in the fires, officials reported Wednesday, and more than 1,100 homes and businesses were destroyed. About 600,000 electricity customers across California were without power, many because power companies shut down their lines to avoid sparking more fires.

“Last night was one of the most devastating and terrifying nights that we’ve seen in any part of our city, in any part of our history,” Marqueece Harris-Dawson, the president of the Los Angeles City Council, said in a news briefing Wednesday, as the skies above the city were filled with a toxic smoke haze.

In Altadena, north of Los Angeles and adjacent to the city of Pasadena, staff at a senior care facility rushed to push dozens of residents in wheelchairs and on gurneys down the street to a parking lot where emergency workers loaded them into ambulances and other vehicles to take them to safety. The nearby

FIRES, Page A5



Bundle, oh boy

Thursday: Still windy, icy. High 28-33. Low 23-28.

Friday: Better, at last. High 35-40. Low 24-29.

High tide: 6:29 a.m., 7:11 p.m. Sunrise: 7:13 Sunset: 4:30

Weather, Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

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Donald Trump is asking the Supreme Court to delay his planned sentencing Friday in his hush money case. **A2.**

Federal authorities added charges against an undocumented immigrant found with an assault rifle and fentanyl at a Revere shelter. **B1.**

Kelly’s Roast Beef is changing hands after more than seven decades. **D1.** Mike Vrabel appears to be the Patriots’ clear target as their next coach. **C1.**

Father who killed wife, kids, and self had history of issues

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

WEST GREENWICH, R.I. — Danielle L. Arruda’s co-workers at Marinosci Law Group called the police last week and requested a wellness check when they realized the mother of two, who was expecting her third child soon, had not shown up for work in several days.

When local police arrived at the gray house at 15 Cheyenne Trail on Friday, the mail was piled up, untouched for some time. A white pickup truck with New Hampshire plates sat in the driveway, next to a red SUV with Rhode Island plates. A swing set was in the backyard. No one an-

swered the door.

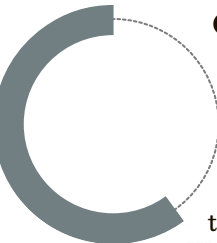
Police had to force their way into the house, where they found a crime scene that West Greenwich Police Chief Richard Ramsay described as “one of the worst” he had seen in more than 30 years.

The bodies of Danielle L. Arruda, 39, Nicholas D. Arruda, 39, and their children, Adele, 5, and Felex, 2, lay on the floor in their pajamas. They had each been shot with a semiautomatic weapon, Ramsay told reporters. The back door was blocked by clutter, and a chain-latch on the locked front door was secured from the inside.

“We may never know why

FAMILY, Page A10

An estimated 60% of formerly incarcerated people are not employed.



There are roughly 3,000 openings in the trucking industry in Mass. and 60,000 nationwide.

For inmates with drive, a chance to move ahead

Program gets them ready to fill one of the many available trucking jobs

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

WORCESTER — Shawn Gallant lost everything when he was sentenced to 18 months in the Worcester County Jail & House of Correction last year for violating probation. His truck. His apartment. Time with his young son. He worries that the plumber’s license he had been working toward may now be difficult to obtain with a felony on his record.

But a few months ago, Gallant found a new way forward. He started training for his

commercial driver’s license, or CDL, under a new partnership between the county sheriff’s office and a tech company that helps people earn learner’s permits while still incarcerated and connects them with truck driving schools upon their release. Once they’ve earned a CDL, the company helps them find trucking jobs, with starting pay averaging \$75,000 a year.

The cost for trainees: \$0. The CDL program, which also accepts recently incarcerated students, is the initiative

TRUCK DRIVERS, Page A7